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DREAM MACHINE | Creative AI News & Insight { July 2026 - Issue 36 }



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July 2, 2026

Welcome to edition 36 of Dream Machine. Covering **AI in the Creative Industries**: Film, Music, Games....

Created and curated by [DreamLab](#), a collective of artists, creative technologists, directors, games & software developers..... including Emmy winners, PhD researchers, and BAFTA recognised talent, thinkers and tinkerers.

You can also listen to the [Dream Machine Podcast](#) 🎧 and for deeper insights and full on analysis, along with some predictions and advice about where this is all going... check out the [Dream Machine: Artificial Intelligence and the Next Creative Economy](#) Book



am Machine #36 | ComfyUI MCP + More News This Week from AI ir

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Editor's Pick:

ComfyUI MCP — the open source engine behind AI's creative future

Few tools in creative AI have scaled as fast, or mattered as much, as ComfyUI. It began in January 2023 as one developer's open-source project — [comfyanonymous](#), then in the orbit of Stability AI — built to give people real control over diffusion models instead of a single prompt box. Three years on it has crossed **4 million users**, drawn **89,000+ GitHub stars** and **60,000+ community-built nodes**, and spun out into a venture-backed company: a \$30m round in April at a **\$500m valuation** (\$48m raised in total). It has become the "operating layer" where a lot of serious generative image and video work now happens.

My own route in was earlier, and more personal. I first came across ComfyUI through Javi, a developer I was working closely with at the time — and the node-graph thinking under the bonnet wasn't new to us. Back in 2022/23 I was already part of a team experimenting with the same foundational tech (which I take zero credit in, but could totally see the value): [litegraph.js](#), the browser-based node-graph engine ComfyUI's interface is built on. What felt like a niche way of wiring tools together then has quietly become how much of the industry now builds.

And not just in theory — in shipped work. Ad studio **Silverside AI** built [SVEDKA's 2026 Super Bowl spot](#) on ComfyUI, billed as the first primarily AI-generated Super Bowl ad. **Series Entertainment** rebuilt its entire game-and-video pipeline on it, scaling past 100,000 assets and [shipping Netflix games](#). Motion studio **Black Math** uses it to turn one-off deliverables into reusable design systems for clients. Comfy Org says [Netflix](#), [Apple](#) and [Ubisoft](#) are now paying customers. And the model labs have fallen in line: Flux, Stable Diffusion, Alibaba's Wan, Tencent's Hunyuan and ByteDance's Seedance now ship with a ComfyUI workflow as standard documentation — ComfyUI has become the integration target for new models the way Hugging Face became the target for weights.

The reason is flexibility, and creative control.

Where closed platforms hide the process behind a prompt, ComfyUI exposes the whole pipeline as a visual graph of nodes. You can chain models, wire in controls, and turn a lucky one-off into a repeatable production system — the workflow itself becomes an asset a team can version, share and reason about. As foundation models improve, that control layer gets *more* valuable, not less: the bottleneck shifts from "can the model do it?" to "can I direct it precisely, every time?" It's picks-and-shovels economics for the creative economy. As Comfy's CEO put it, "we are not trying to win the next benchmark" — the bet is that whatever model wins, the layer that lets a human steer it is the thing that endures. It is also why the market is bifurcating: closed consumer apps like Midjourney on one side, and on the other a professional layer — VFX houses, ad agencies, game studios — that has consolidated almost entirely on ComfyUI's graph.

The reason it earns the pick *this week* is that this week ComfyUI launched [Comfy MCP](#) in public beta — pitched as the first Model Context Protocol server built for real production pipelines rather than one-off generations. (MCP is the open standard for wiring AI assistants to tools.) Point an agent like Claude, Codex, Cursor or Hermes at it and you can build, edit and run workflows in plain language, search models and nodes, and — crucially — share a workflow URL so a teammate's agent runs the *exact same* pipeline, every generation reproducible. The tagline says it plainly: "turn your agent into a creative technologist." Because it runs on Comfy Cloud there's no local GPU needed; community servers have offered versions of this for a while, but this is the official, production-grade

one. The shift is from AI that *makes* content to AI that can *operate* a creative system.

Here's the bigger story, and it's the one for creatives to sit with.

The ideas open platforms like ComfyUI pioneered are now steering the incumbents.... from the model aggregators (Higgsfield, Weavy, Runway) to the big boys. In April, Adobe launched its Firefly AI Assistant — an agent that orchestrates multi-step jobs across Photoshop, Premiere and Illustrator from plain language — and previewed [Project Graph](#), a node-based editor for wiring AI models, Adobe tools and effects into shareable "capsules."

This is important.

Read that again: Adobe is building node graphs and a multi-model roster, and openly treating the connective infrastructure *between* its apps — not any single app — as where the value now sits. That is ComfyUI's thesis, arriving in San Jose. The innovation didn't come from the biggest company in the room. It came from an open ecosystem, and the biggest company is now following and copying it.

Which is why open source matters in the creative economy — not as ideology, but as leverage. **Opening the black box gives creators a say over the tools, the models, and the decisions and consequences baked into the values behind them:** room for models trained differently, transparent development, systems that answer to the communities using them rather than a single vendor's roadmap.

That's the real hook here. ComfyUI isn't just a powerful tool. It's a signal that the next generation of creative studios may be built on open, programmable pipelines — not closed software platforms — and that the people doing the creative work get to keep their hands on the controls.



Video, Film, TV & Animation

- The Rise of ComfyUI: How One Guy's Side Project Took Over AI Image Generation [LINK](#)
- Adobe announced its intent to acquire [Topaz Labs](#) [LINK](#)
- Google is looking for the next wave of creatives across all mediums to join our 6-week residency with Google Flow [LINK](#)
- Netflix says it will use AI, external to recreate the voice of the late Gene Wilder in a new reality TV series set in the world of Willy Wonka & the Chocolate Factory. [LINK](#)
- Nearly 1,000 actors, talent agents, parents and others have signed an open letter condemning contract clauses that require child actors to sign over their voices for AI [LINK](#)

- 25 years ago, this scene from Steven Spielberg's 'A.I.' predicted the collapse of objective reality [LINK](#)
- Vibe Directing? An AI Startup Run by Ex-Googlers Say Their New Model Can Make It Happen (Exclusive) [LINK](#)
- Runway announces strategic partnership with MIXI, one of Japan's largest gaming, sports and entertainment companies [LINK](#)
- AI Video Startup Higgsfield Hits \$500M Revenue, Eyes \$5B Funding Round [LINK](#)
- Peppa Pig Contract Backlash Is the Latest Over the Use of AI in Entertainment [LINK](#)
- PMG's hackathon at Cannes signals agencies' growing appetite for AI talent [LINK](#)
- Hollywood Workers Are Training AI Models as Job Prospects Grow Slim [LINK](#)
- 'Sheep in the Box': Neon Drops First Trailer for Hirokazu Koreeda's AI Family Drama [LINK](#)
- Animation's AI Reckoning: Filmmakers Say They Can Better Make Movies for 90% Less [LINK](#)
- A24 Is Dealing With a Full-on Crisis Among Fans After Signing an AI Deal With Google [LINK](#)
- Cate Blanchett, Steven Soderbergh, Nikki Hexum on How the Human Consent Registry Helps People Protect Their Identity From AI Theft: It's a 'Human Right' [LINK](#)

Games, Immersive & Interactive

- Epic Games CEO Criticizes Valve's AI Disclosure Policy for Steam - arguing access to AI tools is essential for smaller studios survival in the competitive landscape [LINK](#)
- EA: AI is delivering "faster prototyping" and a "real rise in creativity" in its studios [LINK](#)
- AI drives a boom in new games but big developers dominate [LINK](#)
- 181,000 mobile games released in last 6 months - AI and vibe coding have unleashed a flood of new games, but not necessarily better ones [LINK](#)
- General Intuition raises \$320M at \$2.3B valuation for AI frontier models based on gameplay [LINK](#) + General Intuition's \$2.3B bet that video games can train AI agents for the real world [LINK](#)
- Open source game engine Godot will no longer accept AI-authored code contributions [LINK](#)
- Tech firms are blaming AI for mega device and console price rises [LINK](#)
- Savvy Games Group partners with Genvid and Massive Studios to expand AI access for Saudi developers [LINK](#)

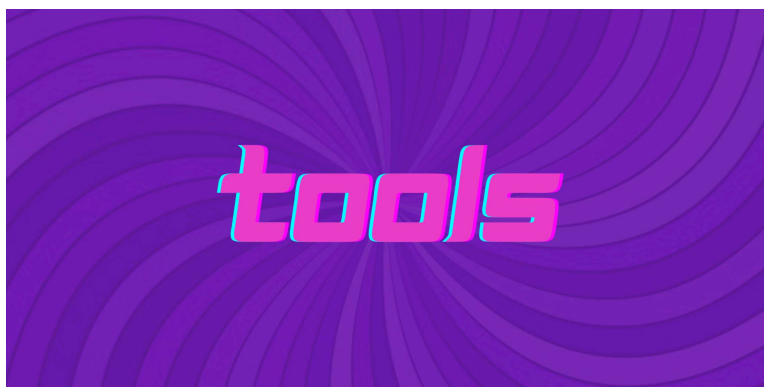
Music & Sound

- YouTube's AI Training Argument Raises Alarm Among Indie Music Advocates: 'Not Informed Consent' [LINK](#)
- Suno is launching Spark, a new incubator program designed to support the next generation of creators. [LINK](#)
- ElevenLabs partners with Google Deepmind - Detecting audio generated by ElevenLabs with SynthID [LINK](#)
- Spotify seeking to grow ad business via AI ad voice-overs and automation [LINK](#)
- Deezer Leapfrogs Spotify With 'Remix Lab'—With No AI Use [LINK](#)
- Tidal allows AI-generated music – but it won't earn royalties [LINK](#)

- Is your track in the datasets that are being used to train AI? The Atlantic unveils a way you can find out [LINK](#)
- AI background music startup Tringbox is also working with live venues [LINK](#)
- Traxsource to introduce labels to identify both human-made and AI-assisted music [LINK](#)
- Google Doubles Down on 'Fair Use' AI Training, Stressing That 'Outputs' Not 'Inputs' Are Where Enforcement Should Be Focusing [LINK](#)
- Backstreet Boys Look to Decommission AI Deepfakes by Trademarking Their Voices — Joining Taylor Swift, Lionel Richie, and Others [LINK](#)
- Madonna Calls AI 'the Complete Opposite of Making Art' While Advocating for a Completely Different Creative Process [LINK](#)

More Creative & AI News

- A Reddit user built an AI fact-checker that checks politicians' claims in real time while they are speaking. [LINK](#)
- TikTok launches Agentic Hub - a central location for third-party artificial intelligence ad tools, and is directly integrated with the platform's MCP server [LINK](#)
- YouTube Content Creators Are Winning the AI Search Game, Jellyfish Data Finds [LINK](#)
- What Cannes Lions 2026 Revealed About the Future of Marketing in the AI Era - conversation, collaboration, and real-world connection. [LINK](#)
- Adobe Introduces Firefly Foundry to Support Custom AI Models for Enterprise Brand Consistency [LINK](#)
- Facebook rolls out an AI companion app for creators [LINK](#)
- Top CFOs warn AI success depends on training employees, not just buying technology [LINK](#)
- 'We can fix the internet ...' says World Wide Web inventor Tim Berners-Lee [LINK](#)
- YouTube adds AI-powered comment filtering [LINK](#)
- Lenovo launches kid-friendly AI phone with no games, GPS tracking & parental controls [LINK](#)



Tool Drops and Tutorials

Comfy MCP

- Comfy MCP in public beta, the first MCP built for production pipelines [LINK](#)

ComfyUI MCP Tutorial: Connect Claude or Codex to smallzero



Watch on

- New in Runway, you can now localize [ads](#).[LINK](#)
- **Krea 2** is back with open weights, including a model for inference and one for training [LINK](#)

Gemini 3.1 Flash Lite/Omni Things

- Google unveils Nano Banana 2 Lite aka Gemini 3.1 Flash-Lite for low cost, 4-second fast enterprise image generations [LINK](#)

Gemini Omni

- Google also released Gemini Omni Flash: to generate and edit high-quality videos via the Gemini API or in Google AI Studio (and also in ComfyUI etc) [LINK](#)
- NVIDIA Metropolis Blueprint for video search and summarization (VSS) 3 is here. Now your coding agent can analyze massive live streams and libraries of videos with a simple natural language prompt.. [LINK](#)
- Google's Gemini Launches New AI Music Model, Lyria 3 [LINK](#)

Supervision

- supervision just hit 40,000 GitHub stars, it powers over 6.5k **open-source** computer vision projects, [LINK](#)
- Seedance 2.0 Mini is now available in ComfyUI. [LINK](#)
- Magnific Plugin inside Premiere Pro, After Effects, DaVinci Resolve, and Final Cut Pro [LINK](#)
- DreamForge: A sandbox for interactive worlds [LINK](#)
- Claude can now generate audio via Higgsfield MCP. [LINK](#)

Mint - rig and animate in minutes

- Mint can now rig and animate your model in 10 mins [LINK](#)
 - Claude Sonnet 5 is out- stronger agentic capabilities, lower pricing, and improved safety, [LINK](#)
-

Face Anything

- Face Anything: 4D Face Reconstruction from Any Image Sequence [LINK](#)
- collision/proxy mesh generation in Supersplat, It uses splat-transform under the hood to generate meshes exportable to GLB [LINK](#)
- a ComfyUI custom node to generate a 3D motion reference with Three.js [LINK](#)
- NVidia Tao Skills Bank - Portable agent skills for training, evaluating, and running inference on NVIDIA TAO models. [LINK](#)
- Open Source Face Recognition SDK [LINK](#)
- Grok Voice Agent Builder: a no-code platform to create human-like voice agents with Grok Voice. [LINK](#)

Next Time...

If you've got any recommendations, opportunities or news we need to know about for our next edition please feel free to reach out.



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